

Qiulan Tao

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EDUCATION

Indiana University Bloomington - Ph.D. in Economics

Fall 2024-present

- Ph.D. Core Examinations: High Pass in Microeconomics and Macroeconomics.

The London School of Economics and Political Science - M.Sc. in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics

Jun 2017

Nanjing University - Master of Economics

Jun 2017

- Honor Thesis: "The study on local power and cyclical central power in ancient China from a moral hazard perspective."

Nanjing University - Bachelor of Economics

Jun 2014

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Behavioral Macroeconomics; Expectations Formation and Belief Heterogeneity; Heterogeneous-Agent DSGE Modeling (HANK); Policy Transmission

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Willingness to Pay for Macroeconomic Stabilization: An Incentivized Experimental Approach

Sep 2025-present

Graduate Research Project

- Designed an incentivized laboratory experiment to measure households' willingness to pay for eliminating business-cycle volatility in solo and strategic environments.
- Developed a two-player public-goods mechanism to study how beliefs about others' contributions shape stabilization demand and social-belief sensitivity.

Macro Instability as a Systemic Shock: A Recursive VAR Approach

Sep 2025-present

Graduate Research Project

- Estimated a recursive VAR to study how inequality shocks and standard macroeconomic shocks jointly propagate to political instability in the U.S.

Ancient China Political Cycle Research from a New Institutional Economics Perspective

Sep 2016-Jun 2017

National Social Science Foundation of China project (Approval Code: 15BJL063)

- Studied centralization and decentralization cycles using a multi-agent moral hazard framework and historical data from 221 BC to AD 1911.
- Master's thesis received Honor Thesis distinction (top 6%); related work later appeared as a book chapter.

PUBLICATIONS

- Q. Tao (2023), "Decentralization, moral hazard and the cyclical rise and fall of feudal dynasties," in D. Yang (ed.), Periodical Rise and Fall of Feudal Dynasties in China: A Study from the Perspective of New Institutional Economics. Zhonghua Book Company, pp. 221-274.
- Q. Tao (2022), "The study on local power and cyclical central power in ancient China from a moral hazard perspective" (MA thesis, Nanjing University).
- Q. Tao (2017), "Studies on Kwoh-Ting Li's Financial Thoughts," in D. Yang (ed.), Studies on Kwoh-Ting Li's Economic Thoughts. Nanjing University Press, pp. 202-247.
- D. Yang, Q. Tao and Z. Zhou (2014), "Organizing or Not: The Evolution of the Peasants Organizing Pattern in China and the Relevant Issues in the Process of Agricultural Modernization," China Development, 14(1), pp. 61-68.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

PhD Math Camp (Graduate Prep Program) - Instructor

Aug 2025

Department of Economics, Indiana University Bloomington

- Independently taught core mathematical foundations for incoming PhD students, including real analysis, optimization, dynamic programming, calculus, and matrix algebra.

Optimization Theory (Graduate Core Course) - Teaching Assistant

Aug 2025-Oct 2025

Department of Economics, Indiana University Bloomington

- Supported instruction in constrained optimization, Lagrangian methods, KKT conditions, and numerical techniques; held weekly recitations and office hours.

ADDITIONAL RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Nanjing University, Economics Department - Graduate Research Assistant Sep 2014-Nov 2014

- Contributed to research on Kwoh-Ting Li's economic thought and Taiwan's economic development; findings were later included in a published book chapter.

Nanjing University, Economics Department - Undergraduate Research Assistant Sep 2013-Feb 2014

- Studied farmer organizational patterns in China and contributed to a paper published in China Development.

From Feudalism to Centralization - Undergraduate Researcher Sep 2013-Nov 2013

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Heren IT - CEO Assistant Aug 2017-present

- Conducted strategy research related to product transformation in healthcare IT and coordinated product strategy and R&D projects.

SWS Research - Intern Stock Analyst, Telecommunications and Technology Jun 2016-May 2017

- Built quantitative financial models and wrote in-depth equity research reports on public technology companies.

AWARDS & HONORS

National Scholarship, First Prize (2014, 2015, 2016); Nanjing University 16th Forum of Sciences and Arts, Third Prize (2013); 24th Silver Star Cup Student Academic Thesis Competition, Excellent Thesis (2013); Nanjing University Business School, Excellent Undergraduate Student (2013); People's Scholarship: Third Prize (2011, 2013), Second Prize (2012).

SKILLS

Programming & Modeling: Python, MATLAB, R, Stata, Fortran, Git/GitHub, LaTeX, Dynare, RISE Toolbox, HANK simulation, Kalman filtering, Bayesian estimation

Econometrics & Data Analysis: Time-series and panel econometrics, VAR/SVAR estimation, numerical optimization, Bloomberg Terminal, Wind Database

Experimental Platforms: oTree